

# Uddannelsesmuligheder efter folkeskolen



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Colombia. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

That's a great and exciting point in your life—you have lots of opportunities ahead! Let's break down your situation and consider options thoughtfully:

## What I know about you

- ✓ You're 16 years old
- ✓ Born and raised in Denmark, fluent in Danish
- ✓ Your parents are from Colombia (so you might have multicultural strengths!)
- ✓ You've finished **primary school** (in Denmark, this usually means *folkeskolen* up to 9th or 10th grade)

## Common educational paths after primary school in Denmark

Here are the main options for young people at your stage:

### Gymnasiale uddannelser (General upper secondary education)

These prepare you for higher education (university). Options include:

- **STX** (*Almen studentereksamen*): Broad academic program
- **HHX** (*Højere handelseksamen*): Focus on business and economics
- **HTX** (*Højere teknisk eksamen*): Focus on technology and science
- **HF** (*Højere forberedelseksamen*): Shorter (2-year) version for those wanting university access but prefer practical subjects

### Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational education and training, VET)

These combine school and apprenticeship (praktik). You can qualify as, for example, an electrician, chef, carpenter, IT-supporter, etc.

### Kombinerede muligheder

Some programs combine academic and vocational tracks (e.g., EUX: both studentereksamen + apprenticeship).

## Things to consider when choosing

- ✓ **What subjects do you like most?** (e.g., languages, math, science, arts, business)
- ✓ **How do you prefer to learn?** (More theoretical at school, or practical with hands-on work?)
- ✓ **Do you plan to go to university later?**

- ✓ **Do you want to start working sooner or keep studying longer?**
  - ✓ **Do you want an international angle?** (e.g., study programs with focus on languages, business, or technical fields that could connect to Colombia or other countries)
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## ☀ **My recommendations**

👉 If you enjoy academic subjects and think about university:

- **STX** if you like a broad education and want to keep options open
- **HHX** if you like business, international trade, marketing
- **HTX** if you like science, technology, or engineering

👉 If you prefer to get into the job market sooner or like hands-on learning:

- **Vocational training (erhvervsuddannelse)** in an area you're passionate about (e.g., IT, gastronomy, mechanics, design, healthcare)

👉 If you want both:

- **EUX**: combines VET with general upper secondary, so you can work and still have the option of university

👉 If you think you'd like to study or work internationally:

- Look for programs that offer bilingual courses, international business, or technical subjects in demand globally
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## ✉ **Next steps**

- ✓ Talk to a *UU-vejleder* (youth guidance counselor) — they can help you find schools and programs that match your interests
  - ✓ Visit some gymnasier or vocational schools — many have open house events
  - ✓ Ask people in your network (teachers, family, friends) about their experiences
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If you'd like, I can help you:

- 💡 explore schools near where you live
- 💡 suggest programs based on your interests (tell me what subjects or jobs you like!)
- 💡 draft a plan for your next 3–5 years

Would you like help with that? 😊